

Speaker1: [00:00:02] So, is there a name or a word you prefer for when we refer to your partner, spouse, partner, boyfriend? Is there a word you are more comfortable with?

Speaker2: [00:00:17] He is my husband.

Speaker1: [00:00:18] Your husband.

Speaker2: [00:00:19] We've been married for [50-55] years. We met when we were [16-20], so you see.

Speaker1: [00:00:22] Very well, how long have you been with your husband? You told me.

Speaker2: [00:00:27] [50-55] years.

Speaker1: [00:00:28] [50-55] years.

Speaker2: [00:00:29] We celebrated our [50-55] anniversary last year.

Speaker1: [00:00:32] Very well. Well, listen, I'd really like to start by having you tell me about your love story, the relationship you currently have.

Speaker2: [00:00:40] Yes, well, as I told you, we were very young, we were [11-15] and [16-20] respectively, so we met through other people we knew. And then I had... We can't say it was love at first sight because I don't know what that means. Let's say I liked him because he was nice. And then I especially admired him in certain areas, and I think love also... This is personal to me because it's a personal interview, but love also includes admiration. For a lot of events that happened, I had a form of admiration for him. We were friends because at [11-15] and [16-20], especially in our time, relationships were far from what they are today. For example, we have a granddaughter who is [16-20], and we didn't live the same life at all. We had a much stricter life. We had parents who, but we don't regret it at all. And so, gradually, we went out with friends, like going to the cinema, doing little outings in [City]. And since we were in the [City] suburbs, doing little outings in [City], etc. Then gradually, it turned into love and we got married when we were [20-25] and [20-25] and a half respectively because we're exactly [16-20] months apart. I'm the older one. So it was something gradual, but we met very young and there was already the feeling of love right away which evolved into love. It's not more complicated than that.

Speaker1: [00:02:21] Yeah.

Speaker2: [00:02:21] That's it.

Speaker1: [00:02:23] I would like you to tell me maybe a little more in detail about the meeting itself, the circumstances.

Speaker2: [00:02:30] The circumstances. Our parents were part of a community, and we found ourselves in this community that we have since left, in which we grew up young, in which we got

married, which suited us when we were young. And then with the years, let's say the transformations of an adult in his mental scheme. That is to say, we might ask ourselves questions differently, or we might ask ourselves the same questions, but we might not necessarily expect the same answers. So there you go, we evolved, but we met in a community in which our parents made us grow. We met like that.

Speaker1: [00:03:22] A community. It's a community of...

Speaker2: [00:03:25] Religious.

Speaker1: [00:03:26] Religious.

Speaker2: [00:03:27] That's right.

Speaker1: [00:03:30] So, you met in this community. Do you remember who made the first move, for example?

Speaker2: [00:03:36] The first moves. Let's say we arrived at this place. My mom had moved, so I followed her. I come from divorced parents. And so we were invited. It started like that. We were simply invited by his parents to get to know each other, and that's how it started. So I was incorporated into this community among young people. That's what I explained to you in the preamble. We started going out with each other, but we felt mutually attracted, so we can't really say that one of us made the first move. I think we made them simultaneously. Yeah, it's all a long time ago. You realize I'm going to be [70-75] years old, so I have to remember what I lived at [16-20]. No, I'm teasing you because no, indeed, I have all those memories. They are good memories. He wrote a lot. There was that. He wrote a lot to me, and I reread them [1-5] year ago. We reread them not long ago because they are in a box behind me, as we are. I'm in the office here, and he wrote a lot to me, so he was quite a poet. So, when you are a [16-20]-year-old girl and you receive such poetic letters, you can't help but be very sensitive to the personality of such a young man.

Speaker2: [00:05:10] So there was that. He wrote a lot to me because you see, I'm trying... So, my little window opens in my brain to go very, very far back. And so indeed, there was a lot of correspondence, even though we saw each other regularly because we saw each other at least every week without necessarily going out every week, but we saw each other at least every week. But there was a lot of correspondence, and we can say that the correspondence, he started it. I'm sure of that. He started it because he had a certain form of shyness. We were young. He was younger than me. So imagine yourself, I suppose you are in your early [20-25], around [20-25], [20-25] years maybe. So my husband was [11-15]. Imagine being [11-15] years old and writing such poems that I couldn't help but be captivated. It's maybe a strong word, but yes, by such talent somewhere, yes. So we can say it started with his writing.

Speaker1: [00:06:16] You mentioned both falling in love quite quickly? Yeah. Can you tell me a little more in detail what happened after and the course of the years?

Speaker2: [00:06:31] Relatively, it was... On my side, I had to... By force of circumstances, he could see that I was really attached to him because my dad got involved in this relationship, did not accept it, and threw me out. So I was kicked out, meaning I couldn't go see him anymore. I used to see him every weekend, roughly every [1-5] weeks because I was living with my mom at that time, my dad was remarried, and so it was very painful because my dad and my stepmother did everything to stop this relationship, and I didn't give up. We got engaged, and after that, I never saw my father again. He never came to my wedding. Well, we reconnected later with my father, but years later, I already had my children. And so, if you will, it started... Well, I can explain that this relationship, this situation only strengthened our relationship to the extent that I didn't hesitate. Well, too bad, my father didn't want to see me. Moreover, it was not the same, let's say, we had different social backgrounds, and I didn't hesitate to disregard everything my father had told me to see our relationship through to the end and get married.

Speaker2: [00:08:17] I think from the beginning we mutually gave each other proofs of our attachment because nothing ultimately separated us. Even if it meant being less connected with my paternal family, everything related to my paternal family, to continue to see our project through to the end and get married. And we did well because, yes, we are still together, we have [1-5] beautiful children, [1-5] beautiful grandchildren. So there you go, even though life has not been a bed of roses because I can't remember who said life is a bed of roses, but I think they were far from reality. So there you go. So to go back to the start, I think also there were events that proved our attachment from the start and that it was not a little romance because if it were a little romance, I don't think I would have given up. I would have accepted having those ties cut with my paternal family if the feelings were not real, even though we were both young.

Speaker1: [00:09:36] Yes, you said your father refused this relationship. For what reason did he refuse this relationship?

Speaker2: [00:09:43] A bunch of reasons. First, because my father is someone who is interested in having, not in being. So the first question he asked me when I said I was seeing someone was, "What do his parents do?" Well, I said, "What does it matter what his parents do? I'm not marrying the parents." But I explained, "I'm his father, what does he do?" He is a [occupation] in a [company], and my father said, "Yes, [occupation], that means [occupation]. We don't have [occupation] in the family, you won't bring one in." So he judged personalities in a very intelligent way. So this first reason, and the second, being part of a community he was against.

Speaker1: [00:10:45] So if I understand correctly, there was a social class difference that didn't please your father, and also he was anti-religious.

Speaker2: [00:10:53] Yes, yes, exactly.

Speaker1: [00:10:55] Which was not the case.

Speaker2: [00:10:56] My stepmother, too, did everything to get me out of the family. But that's another problem.

Speaker1: [00:11:08] So then, you stay with your husband, you cut ties with your father, or rather your father cuts ties with you. How does it go at that moment in your relationship? Do you move in together, for example? You mentioned getting married. Can you talk a bit more about that?

Speaker2: [00:11:31] Yes, at that time, you... Given the age compared to today, or to mentalities... not mentalities, that's not what I mean, to the current way of living, maybe you might find it amusing, but since we're in confidences, my husband and I had a chaste life, let's say, until we got married. Because we got married very young, he lived with his parents, I lived with my mom, and we only lived together when we got married. So I feel like I'm on another planet here.

Speaker1: [00:12:23] So at what age did you get married?

Speaker2: [00:12:25] We were [20-25] and a half, and my husband was exactly [20-25] because he was born in [Month]. We got married in [Month], so he was [20-25] years and [1-5] months old.

Speaker1: [00:12:33] I see.

Speaker2: [00:12:34] So it may seem completely unreal today.

Speaker1: [00:12:40] But, well, something understandable, you see.

Speaker2: [00:12:43] And we regret nothing about the wedding. It represented so many things.

Speaker1: [00:12:51] Yes, it represented a lot of things.

Speaker2: [00:12:53] It was not just a simple engagement on a piece of paper. There were many other events tied to getting married. It was our deep thoughts.

Speaker1: [00:13:09] Yes.

Speaker2: [00:13:10] I understand that today things happen differently, and I am very respectful of the life each person can lead. But we had this kind of life.

Speaker1: [00:13:24] So this wedding...

Speaker2: [00:13:25] We waited for it for many reasons. Now you can understand.

Speaker1: [00:13:33] So you get married. I'd like you to tell me more about what happens after the wedding.

Speaker2: [00:13:41] We had an amazing honeymoon for [1-5] month. We were on a beautiful island, [City]. Sometimes you don't need to go to the middle of the [City] or [City]. Know that we have a beautiful little island. I don't know if you know it, and if you don't, I encourage you to visit this beautiful island, [City], which is magnificent. So we spent an amazing time on this island.

And then after, we came back like any young couple, living our lives, going to work. I worked at the time, going to work, all excited to have our little apartment, decorating it our way because one of the things I admire about my husband is that he can do everything without having learned it. He can do everything, he has taste, so we complement each other. That's also important in a couple, complementarity, and I think that's what we have. They say opposites attract. They also say like attracts like. So it's completely... It's quite difficult because they are at the antipodes. We resemble each other, we assemble, and we are opposites and we find each other. So what should we believe? Both. We need to resemble each other and have some differences to do a lot of things together, and that makes a bit of everything.

Speaker2: [00:15:27] So we need all the elements. And in the end, it results in something very constructive, very beautiful. I already had this admiration because, like all young couples, we didn't have a lot of money, so we made do with what we had, saving to buy the most important things, and we knew how to wait. I think when you wait a little, there is even more satisfaction. The word happiness might be a bit big, satisfaction is more fitting, to achieve things. Meanwhile, he made a beautiful bedroom, a beautiful library, and since I think I have taste, with simple little things, we managed to create a little nest, and everyone loved our little place. We were proud of it. So to explain how we started, we did many things with our hands, our minds, our tastes, and combined our skills. That's how we started. Professionally, my husband didn't have the chance because of various very difficult events in his family, so he stopped his studies and started working very young.

Speaker2: [00:16:58] But as someone particularly intelligent, in the company he worked for, he took all the training and, with a [educational attainment] level, he became a [occupation] in a big company [6-10] years later, responsible for half of [Country]. So with a [educational attainment] level. When I spoke of admiration, it also helps in strengthening a couple to see that someone gives themselves the means. He didn't have them young, but he found the means, and with a well-made mind, he succeeded. So it's not about his social success, because otherwise, it would mean... Yes, I was proud, but proud in a good sense, not of the position he had achieved, but proud of everything he did to get there. So all these elements make, I think, that throughout life, he has never been static, if you will. So surely, it allows to strengthen the bonds. That's everything I feel. I might not express myself very well, but...

Speaker1: [00:18:41] Don't worry. I understand what you're saying.

Speaker2: [00:18:43] That's it.

Speaker1: [00:18:47] I'd like you to tell me more about the development of the relationship between you and him.

Speaker2: [00:18:55] As I told you, there was this professional evolution. After [1-5] years, we had a child. My dream was to be able to raise him, and my husband said no problem if you want to raise our child. I quit my job and raised our child. Unfortunately, because we have lived until many years ago and still have this sword of Damocles hanging over our heads, unfortunately, our eldest son is very seriously ill. He was connected to a machine for [6-10] years. And then,

thank God, he was able to have a transplant. So to tell you that this very, very painful event often in couples, we have seen around us, some couples who live a tragedy either separate or get closer. We have known couples with problems. It either separates them or strengthens their bonds. And to answer all your questions about our couple relations, our child's health problem, the serious health problems, it was not hay fever, which made our bonds even stronger because we were united. We couldn't do anything, unfortunately.

Speaker2: [00:20:34] But being strong together to live through the painful situation we were living and still live today. He is [46-50] years old, [46-50]. So he is transplanted. But it's true that he has the sword of Damocles hanging over his head. But, carpe diem, we enjoy the present moment. Everything is fine for him. But to say that this event accompanied us, then, well, we discovered his illness when he was [1-5]. So you see, he was [1-5], he is [46-50]. So the health problem of our son also made us even more united to give him the maximum happiness. Then he has a little sister, a little brother, and we really had these strong bonds to protect our family. Firstly, I didn't want my children to live what I had experienced. And then our child's health problem, we wanted him to be in good family conditions. Of course, there were mistakes, surely like everyone else, because there is no manual for being a parent. Everything we did throughout our life was always with our heart, even now.

Speaker1: [00:22:06] You mentioned your relationship, that of your friends, where you said that sometimes hard events like that can unite or separate couples. If you had to compare the quality of your relationship with that of your friends, what would you say?

Speaker2: [00:22:29] Not my friends, but more. My friends, among others, the closest ones. Well, you know them. At least, it's [Friend's Name] and [Friend's Name]. [Friend's Name] who will give to [Friend's Name]. So the [Friend's Name], we met when we got married. You see, we have [50-55] years of friendship. And if we compare, we have about the same thing because we lived through similar things. Well. Other friends and our other friends. The friends we frequent and with whom we are connected for many years. We have the same functioning. So. If you will. If I compare, to answer the question about our friends, our friends who are loyal friends because there are friends, there are buddies, it's different. I'm talking about friends, we really have three couples of friends we've known for almost forever, respectively [50-55] years, two couples, and [40-45] years the third. Then we have pals, good relations. We continue, especially my husband with one of his former, two of his former colleagues, in the company I told you about, he worked, he evolved, so it's been more than [40-45] years now. Well, he was there, you see, at our [50th-55th] wedding anniversary. So it continues. My husband is a loyal person in friendship. And so we hang out. Apart from one couple, the other had a totally different life. Because as much as he appreciated him on a human level, but well, we don't compare because it was diametrically opposed if you will, in terms of family life, especially him in fidelity, if we can say.

Speaker2: [00:24:27] But after it's not that he wasn't his friend or mine. He leads the life he wants, it doesn't concern me. So to say, no, comparing really my friends, our friends, because my friends are his friends, so they are our intimate friends. If we compare, we have about... Of course, we haven't all experienced the same things, but a couple of friends didn't experience health problems like we did. They had other problems because there weren't just health issues.

After, my husband lost his job, so it was something else. So we had, and maybe that's also, surely, what makes these relationships strong, is that like many, we had quite a few problems. So our son's health, my husband losing his job, and we sold our house. But all that, instead of saying we can throw everything away, we're fed up with problems, all the problems we have experienced have only been means of, let's say, strengthening our couple.

Speaker1: [00:25:42] I see, you were talking about what for you constitutes a relationship of high quality.

Speaker2: [00:25:48] Trust already. I think I said that the other day to my granddaughter, discussing with my granddaughter, because I am quite close, quite close with my [16-20]-year-old granddaughter, who just graduated, and we are very proud. For me, yes, for me, I think it's the same. It's trust. If you don't trust someone, like your spouse, nothing can work. Hum. Well, it's personal to me. And I have complete trust in all areas. Of course, everyone is imperfect or makes mistakes, etc. But I have complete trust in my husband. And just as I trust friends. So for me, if there is trust, it is the primary quality for human relations, both in the couple and with friends, in family. Human relations, in general, are based on trust. If you don't trust someone, I don't think you can maintain interesting relationships if there is no trust.

Speaker1: [00:27:04] Hum. How can you tell if you're in a relationship of trust?

Speaker2: [00:27:08] That's a good question. We are entering philosophical debates. I think it's innate. It must be innate, instinctive. And certain elements. I think if you put certain elements, certain occasions that have happened, I don't know how to explain it. For me, it would be easier on paper because I am more comfortable with paper than verbally. But trust is something you feel. And if the elements, life, show that you can trust someone, if you see that the person has always been there, if the person doesn't hurt you in any way. Well, when I say harm, harm can be in simpler situations. Harm is not necessarily physical harm. There is also intellectual harm, harm in words, harm. And when you see the stability of the person, the stability of the person. I was talking about his job, and indeed, in his job. He is still in contact with two of his colleagues, one who was his [occupation], and one who was a collaborator of my husband. So my husband was his [occupation]. You see, there were the three hierarchies. They all get along very well. And I heard it from the mouth of his boss, [Name]. [Name] said my husband is someone you can trust.

Speaker2: [00:29:01] He leads projects and proposes things. He always shows up when needed. So already, even in the professional field, I heard the word trust. And I have always had it since we met, since we were very young, since... You see, it's hard to explain because it's something you feel. Well, I don't know how you feel trust or how others may feel it. For me, it's innate. I see it in my professional environment because I worked after. I went back. I was in national education for the last [20-25] years, passed exams after. And it's something I feel even with people I worked with almost instinctively, let's say. This one, I wouldn't trust. I don't know why. I couldn't explain it to you. And then, finally, over time, in certain events that happened, I could see that I was not mistaken. It was someone who was not in line with what they were saying. So, you see, do what I say, don't do what I do. For me, I can't trust. But someone who

says things and does exactly what they say. Personally, it's someone I can trust, but there you go. I might not be very clear, but it's hard to explain. I will have neurons overheating.

Speaker1: [00:30:37] When would you say your relationship was most based on trust?

Speaker2: [00:30:42] All the time, from the beginning, from the beginning. How could I say no because I always had... For example, at one point, when he was looking for work, he had to travel, even for his job, even when he was in the company he worked for the longest. There were occasions always to travel because he was responsible for half of [Country]. One moment he was in [City], another in [City], another in [City], he saw the agencies where he had colleagues, where he went for several days. So I never worried about anything while I know that when I talk to some, doesn't it bother you that sometimes he tried his best. Often he left very early in the morning because, I tell you, it was half of [Country], so it was [City], [City], central [Country], and the [City]. We lived in [City], he tried, even if it meant leaving at 4 a.m. and coming back at midnight, even sometimes when he had [City], taking the plane to try to come back in the evening. You see, he always tried to come back because he wanted to see the kids. He didn't want to leave me alone with the kids. But well, it happened quite a few times that he was away for several days. I never, it never bothered me or I wondered, to say well my husband with his [department] team. So then, sure, there were evenings when they were together, etc. Never. But I swear on my children's heads that it never bothered me at all to know my husband in the company of others, other people in his work environment. Never, never, never.

Speaker1: [00:32:33] You see?

Speaker2: [00:32:33] So for me, that's trust. Because when some say, doesn't it bother you that your husband is gone? Well, no, why?

Speaker1: [00:32:43] So when, conversely, was this relationship not one of trust?

Speaker2: [00:32:53] No. I can't say that. No, it's difficult as I never asked myself that. So, excuse me. Well, that's not serious. So no, I never asked myself that.

Speaker1: [00:33:14] Yes, take the time to reflect if you wish.

Speaker2: [00:33:17] No. No, for me, it hasn't been like that. It was like that. No, there is no... Well, no, because I don't think I could have stayed with someone I didn't trust. So no, as I was telling you earlier, I discussed it with my granddaughter, etc. No, never. For me, it has always been the same thing, no? No, no, no loss of trust.

Speaker1: [00:33:53] You mentioned trust as a key component of a high-quality relationship. Are there other things that make a relationship high-quality for you?

Speaker2: [00:34:05] Already, the interest we can have in the person. Helping them, even with small things. At the beginning, it wasn't very easy. Well, not at the beginning. But I worked, so we got married, and I had my son [1-5] years later. After that, I stopped working for [20-25] years, so I took a long break. I devoted myself to housekeeping, my kids, etc. So my husband



didn't help with the house because, given his work, I couldn't ask him to help after he worked all week. But he helped me, of course, when we had guests. And we received a lot of people. My husband was never the kind to sit idly by. We had guests. On the other hand, yes, he always helped. So all this is part of the little things in life. Life is full of little things, not necessarily grand events. Our daily life is little things. We had guests, everyone left late, etc. Often, there are those who tidy everything up and can't sleep if everything is a mess. I do it today, but when I was younger, it took much longer. When people left at 1 a.m., it was bedtime for me. I'd tidy up the next day. And for example, my husband, who always woke up earlier than me, tidied everything up. It's little things, daily things, but they bring pleasure. It shows the interest my husband has for me. So these little details of life are pleasing. And pleasure makes you want it to continue. If you have little things, it makes life.

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Speaker1: [00:37:26] You spoke to me about what a high-quality relationship is to you. Now I would like you to talk to me about what a low-quality relationship is to you.

Speaker2: [00:37:37] On the other hand, first, there is no interest. For me, a low-quality relationship is when there is no interest in the other person. That is, if the woman doesn't care about what her husband does, what her husband likes, what her husband says, when there is no sharing, when there is no sharing, it is a low-quality relationship. So, you shouldn't, therefore. That's why I come back to what I said earlier, the two proverbs, in quotation marks, which are opposed, namely birds of a feather flock together and opposites attract, is that there must still be a little part. Each one must leave a small part of things, a personal element, a personal life. Okay. For example, I tell you, my husband loves tinkering, you see. We have a house with a big basement, his basement is his space, you see. So, he likes creating, making things, you see. Right now we have a big garden, we are making a vegetable garden. So the vegetable garden, we do it together, and then together we made plans, and now he is making my fences.

Speaker2: [00:38:54] So he is alone in his corner making fences. For example, I like music, we like music, but I like singing. Well, I'm part of a choir, he doesn't come with me to the choir, if he doesn't like the choir, I don't see why I should take him by the hand and drag him to the choir. So, in our relationships, we shouldn't stifle each other either. Each one should, of course, be able to do the things they like, but a large part of things should be enjoyed together. This does not prevent him from doing the things he likes and me from doing the things I like. Of course, I let him do that. I am part of a choir, I go to my choir, but it shouldn't be that each one is always in their own corner, you see, there shouldn't be one who spends their time. I don't know, if he likes sports, goes to soccer, to tennis, and the woman is on the other side, there should be at least.

Speaker2: [00:40:00] There should be things to do together. There are both, things to do together. And then, depending on the personalities, because we are not completely alike either, leave space for each to do the things they like, but being interested in them. You see, like the choir example, my husband says to me, "So, what did you learn? Go ahead, sing me your songs." He doesn't come with me to the choir, but he is interested in what I do. So each should have a personal space with their tastes, but the other must be interested, and if there is a lack of interest, for me, it is a weakness. That's where the couple is not in harmony. There must be harmony while each one maintains their personality, with their tastes. So a little space for each, of course, but we should be interested in what the other does and likes, even if it's not our cup of tea.

Speaker1: [00:41:12] If I understand correctly, you are telling me. You describe the importance of maintaining individuality within the couple?

Speaker2: [00:41:19] Of course.

Speaker1: [00:41:20] And having both freedom.

Speaker2: [00:41:23] Yes.

Speaker1: [00:41:24] And as you say, an interest in the other, even if passions are not necessarily shared.

Speaker2: [00:41:33] Exactly. But there must be some in common, if you will. For me, I find it hard to understand how a couple can last without having at least. Or a passion. Well, not necessarily a passion, let's say an interest. Because, well, not necessarily passion, there should be at least some common interests, otherwise I don't see how it can work, but that's my personal view. It's all personal, depending on the childhood one has had. It so much determines our adult life that it shows the differences of each person. But well, we see it like this now, for the moment it works, we don't always agree, mind you. But well. Most of the time, we talk, especially not staying in our corner. If there is something wrong that we have to reproach each other for. Because sometimes there are things we. So we don't do things as we would like, we would like the other to do and especially talk to each other. Because if we don't talk, the

dialogue, if there is no dialogue, we can't move forward. Because [Name], huh, we don't know what the other expects from us if we don't say it.

Speaker1: [00:43:05] To talk. You say we can't move forward.

Speaker2: [00:43:10] For me, we can't move forward without dialogue, dialogue, listening too. And then try to understand the person, not wanting to impose too. Yeah, if we impose it doesn't work either.

Speaker1: [00:43:23] Hmm, you talk to me about communication, dialogue, the ability not only to talk but also to listen, that is to be able to receive the words. What role does it play in a relationship? Does it increase satisfaction? Of course.

Speaker2: [00:43:41] It can be positive. Yes, I admit, it's true that for a while, for little things, mind you, little things we wanted the partner to do but and we grumble in our corner. Well yes, why doesn't he do this? Why doesn't he do that? Why doesn't he? Well yes, but if we don't ask, he doesn't necessarily know what we want, what we expect, and that's why we have to discuss it and say why. So how could I address this? A very simple thing. The most basic thing possible which. But as I told you, life, the daily life, it's the little things, okay, and it's the things that make the day. So what I expected, so after when. Especially since we retired, we retired at the same time, I said, well, now we're going to have. Even he said yes, it's true, I should participate a bit more in the house chores, and so on. So I told him, for example, why don't you make the bed. I'm telling you a basic thing, huh? And he couldn't. But why? So he wondered. To give you an example, I'm telling you the anecdote, he said, it's true, I can't. Ask me something else, I can't do it. Why can't I do it? I need to understand why. So, since you study psychology, my husband loves to understand what can go on in his head, so why can't I make a bed? He thought about it.

Speaker2: [00:45:33] He went back to his youth and unfortunately my husband lost his mother very early. She died of cancer, so I had the chance to know her unfortunately not for very long, but at the beginning. As I told you about our relationship. So she died of cancer and she was very ill at home for a long time. And it was my husband who helped his mother. And he made this damn bed for her. So by himself. Reflecting, he said, why can't I make a bed? It's not complicated. You don't need a degree to make a bed. He said that's why I hate making the bed. Making the bed reminds me of my sick mother who I helped make the bed, so for him, making the bed, you'll say it's silly, but making the bed was related to his mother's illness and he was unable to make this damn bed. So from one day to the next, he said, well, now the context is different. Well, since then, he makes the bed every day. You see, it's a silly thing. And to tell you how important it is. And that's why they asked me about my attachment to my husband until now. You see, he goes as far as to think about why he didn't want to make this damn bed. So, well. It's silly, it's daily anecdotes, you see, to show how far we go to do things. When?

Speaker1: [00:47:17] You talk to me about communication.

Speaker2: [00:47:18] Yeah, there you go. He goes even further, you see. He seeks the why of the how. It interests him a lot. He says if I were younger? He says really, he says well now we are doing armchair psychology but it's true that he finds it super interesting and so he is very interested in that. There, the parenthesis is closed.

Speaker1: [00:47:42] You talked to me about what a high-quality relationship is for you and what a low-quality relationship is for you. And I would like you to talk to me about the things. If there are other things that are most important to you in a romantic relationship.

Speaker2: [00:47:57] But I think it's what I told you. Most important. There you go, I mean this trust, this presence, this interest in the other, doing things together. Respecting each other. Of course, showing your feelings. That, on that side. My husband knows how to show his feelings because even after [50-55] years of marriage, when we walk, he holds my hand. You see the little, little attentions. You see, we are [70-75] years old, well we are respectively [70-75] and soon [70-75], and we walk and we try to walk every day, at least a good, a good hour minimum, if not more. And instinctively, he always takes my hand. You see, small, small affectionate attentions are also important, even. Even as we age, we need. Physical contact. Yeah. It's hard to explain feelings.

Speaker1: [00:49:31] You talk to me about. Feelings. I would like. Precisely for you to talk to me, based on your experience, about what love is to you.

Speaker2: [00:49:44] Oh, then! Well, already it must be something chemical. Already the interest, the attraction we can have for someone. Why be attracted to one person more than another who may have? There, it's a big philosophical question too because you can have two people who have the same temperaments, let's say the same characters, the same who will do the same things, who will. And why are we attracted to one and not the other, when at the limit, let's say, even if physically they look alike morally, they resemble each other, these two individuals are almost the same, let's say. Why are we more attracted to one than to the other? That, I think is a big question and I wouldn't know how to answer it. There you go. So already it is also something that goes beyond what we can explain. It's irrational in a way. Why be attracted to one person more than another? So as we can say, I can't explain it, it's something natural that is innate. There is this attraction, huh, just like there must be elements that work like when there is a magnet, a well, a magnet doesn't work on all elements, it will only work if it's iron.

Speaker2: [00:51:19] Well, it won't work on wood. So maybe. Well, in humans, it's the same. I don't know, I don't know. So for me, it is instinctive too. As I told you when I met him already. Well. There is something that attracts me to him. Already his look because he has beautiful clear [eye color]. And this look already, we. I can't explain it to you. Already, just the look is attractive, he exuded. You see, it's something that is difficult because it's not tangible, huh, it's something that comes out of an individual. And I know, as I told you, we were very young, huh? And there was almost an attraction. I found that something came out of him. These things, it's. In this young man, I will say then, even though there were many other young people because I told you we were several, we were a small group of friends of the same age or even when we

could be in classes, etc., why be more attracted to someone than to someone else? That is the big question, it's the big question. There is. At the very beginning. Well, first, an attraction, an attraction that happens, that can't be explained.

Speaker2: [00:52:46] And then when you get to know the person, then the more tangible elements, as we said, the character really of the person make that well we. Finally, the friendship we can have at the beginning because we like each other, he is nice, we go out together with other friends, but it turns into love. Why? Well, for all the reasons I told you, there is necessarily a plus for marrying someone more than the friend we frequented at the same time. Well, frequenting, as a friend, of course. Then I don't know. After a while, you stop questioning it. For a long time, I have been happy. So even if I tell you sometimes I am a bit of a volcano, I am from the [location], I have [location] origins so sometimes, while he is always very calm, there you see, we are opposites in that regard because I get worked up very quickly while my husband is very calm. But on the other hand, the day he gets angry because I have seen him angry once or twice, you better hide, huh? Then. There you go, you.

Speaker1: [00:54:08] Talk to me about. The notion of love, what it is for you. Would you say that it is important in a relationship?

Speaker2: [00:54:16] Not the most important, the most important because I think it allowed us to raise children who today are doing quite well. Yes, I think that's an example. Just because we have an example doesn't mean we necessarily follow it. Unfortunately, my eldest son divorced. But there you go. But I think we have children. By being a united couple. I think it allowed, and you would discuss with our children, but having. We have [1-5] children, [1-5] different children but [1-5] balanced children. And my daughter said she wants to follow our example. She celebrated [20-25] years of marriage, and my granddaughter says Oh, when I see everything that happens today, already she says I may already be one of the few in my class to still have parents together, so. But between my grandparents, my parents, well I hope I will do the same. So well, I think we did everything we could for our children and then. We think we are a nice little. A nice little family, even if each one has their own character, their own difficulties. It's not necessarily because of that everything always goes smoothly, huh.

Speaker1: [00:55:43] You talk to me about love. We know there are different forms and ways of loving. I would like you to talk to me about how you know your partner loves you.

Speaker2: [00:55:52] Because I have hearing problems. So you see, I will. What did you say? I read your lips too.

Speaker1: [00:56:00] Yes, I would like you to talk to me about how you know your partner loves you.

Speaker2: [00:56:07] How do I know? Well, I feel it already. And then I think if he didn't love me, sometimes I have a very bad temper, I think he would have packed his bags. No, there too it. It's something that is felt. And then when he does things, he always tries to do things for. For us. For. For our home. For our comfort. We discuss it. Well, I think. Yes, he doesn't have a. He

doesn't have a selfish behavior. I mean whatever we do, sometimes we make sacrifices. It's not the right word because if we make a sacrifice, it doesn't go. Make a sacrifice, we don't sacrifice. Well, don't exaggerate. How can I say. How can I explain it. Yes, each tries to please the other, even if necessarily, how. How can I explain this? If it is trying to prioritize the other, not necessarily before oneself. Because I don't want to say we seem like saints there. How can I explain this? Could you remind me of your question because suddenly, I went off on a tangent.

Speaker1: [00:57:50] I would like you to talk to me about how you know your partner loves you.

Speaker2: [00:57:59] I know it already. Yes, it's. Well, you know how we know we are a boy? How we know we are a girl? It can't be explained. Well, there, I know. Because he asks me first. He always tries to do things that please me too. So there can be compromises because we don't always have the same tastes, the same ideas. He lets me do it, for example. Well, I told you, I like, I like singing, so I'm part of a choir. He, well, he doesn't care much. Too bad because he has a great baritone voice. But so we respect each other there. And already, well, I admit, I don't have a very good character. He must really love me already because I have a bit of a bad character. I have a bit of [location] blood so it's also because he is half [Nationality] and half [Nationality]. So you see the characters he can have. So. I went off again. I don't remember what I was saying. Aging is not fun.

Speaker1: [00:59:33] You talked to me about how you know your partner loves you.

Speaker2: [00:59:36] Ah yes? Well, he always tries to ask me for my opinion. It's this respect. Already the respect we can have for each other. He is far from being selfish, so it's already always asking for my opinion. It's true that afterwards, we make compromises. We make compromises because we can't fully please one and fully please the other. So well, we try to be reasonable and make compromises. For example, when my husband lost his job, we had to sell the house because we still had a mortgage on it. We had to sell our house, we had a beautiful house, we had to sell the house. We moved a bit to the countryside. We are now [70-75] kilometers from our children, well from [1-5] of our children because one moved to the mountains. Because since he was born, he talked about his mountains. So we have one who lives in the [City] so. It's true that when we bought this house, it wasn't at all what I wanted. And. But it's true that we discussed it. Each brought their ideas, their arguments. And then finally, we bought this house even though at first, I barely wanted to visit it. But as I told you, he knows how to do everything. Well, he is rehabilitating it and making it.

Speaker2: [01:01:17] And basically, well, finally, it's as if we were rebuilding it because we redid it completely inside because he tore everything down and redid everything. So you see, sometimes there are sacrifices, although sacrifice is too strong a word. But it's true that well, I didn't say no at first. Yes, I didn't want this house. And you, why do you want it? It takes discussion, but one's arguments and the other's arguments. And yeah, in the end, you are right, it's true, we are near the highway, we are only 1 hour and 3 quarters away, we are at our son's and daughter's place who are in the same area in [City] where we were before. And now the other one moved to the depths of the [City]. So no matter where we are, we have kilometers to do to see our baby. But there you go, he. Sometimes, well, he had his arguments which in the

end, when you weigh them, his arguments were more, they were more important than mine, so well. It wasn't what I wanted, but he is making it as I want it to be. There you go, these are little life details, but well, sometimes you have to because otherwise we would always be fighting.

Speaker1: [01:02:42] I would like you to talk about one of the last positive interactions you had with your husband.

Speaker2: [01:02:48] Positive.

Speaker1: [01:02:49] One of the last positive interactions.

Speaker2: [01:02:52] Anyway, he is always positive then. Positive and last positive. Well, it was regarding our forced move here. Yes, the fact of coming here. And having finally managed to. Because it's material, when we wanted to visit the house. Me, apart from the land, we fell in love with the land because. So. And then finally, we managed to make this house that I didn't want into something great. When you enter, it's very pretty because he knows how to do everything with his hands, he did everything and. So finally, I am very happy to be here when at first, we didn't agree. But each brought their arguments. Well, finally, he was right. Yes.

Speaker1: [01:04:00] Do you have a. A more precise example of a positive interaction you had with your husband?

Speaker2: [01:04:09] Well, it's that one.

Speaker3: [01:04:11] Yes, that one.

Speaker2: [01:04:11] Otherwise, everything else we are. We rarely disagree so. Or if we disagree, it's really small, things so insignificant that I don't even know what we could disagree on, you see, and it's very trivial things so. No? And the main thing is to explain and talk a lot. Especially not stay in your corner. Anyway, I'm from the [location], so I get worked up very quickly and it's important to never stay on something negative but to explain, give reasons for why we don't want this or why we don't want that. And talk a lot, talk a lot. So?

Speaker1: [01:05:07] Yes, yes, the importance of communication. Ah yes! You talked about it earlier.

Speaker2: [01:05:11] The important thing is communication. To talk even about details, even about details. It's not that we always agree, mind you. But we explain, we each explain our reasons and then we. Finally, it's important not to complicate things. I find that sometimes we want to complicate things too much when life can be simple. We already have so many elements we don't have control over. I told you, we had our son's health problems who had to undergo a transplant, I think we had it all. We found out our son was sick at [1-5] years old and he will be [[46-50] soon in [Month]. Okay. My husband lost his job. We had to sell our house.

Speaker3: [01:05:59] Hmm.

Speaker2: [01:06:00] And I think all the hard times we had in life, the biggest one, our son's health. After my husband's job. But we always try to take the positive side. Well, it's because I have a positive husband because I am a worrywart, I would drown in a glass of water. And I think the most important thing sometimes, indeed, for a couple, is to talk. And finally, you know, there is an old saying that opposites attract. And it's true that. In terms of opposites, we're not bad, the two of us. That is, I panic, I would drown in a glass of water. And my husband is a go-getter. And my husband always got out of situations. The proof is he couldn't do the studies he wanted. And he took them up later and took training to the level that he finished with a management position. Okay. So I think also that in a couple, for a couple to work well, even sentimentally speaking, there must be a certain form of admiration. And as far as I'm concerned, I've been very admiring of what he has done.

Speaker1: [01:07:27] Yeah.

Speaker3: [01:07:28] I said.

Speaker2: [01:07:29] We come from two completely different families socially. And. He didn't say for serious reasons, his father gravely ill. Anyway, I skip all these details for family reasons. Stop studying. But he didn't stay in his corner, he said well I couldn't do it when I wanted, well I won't let life beat me like that. I told you the training he took, etc., to quickly have a management position and manage half of [Country] in the company he was in. So attracted therefore to someone with quite extraordinary strength of character. I think that's why in a couple, and that's surely one of the reasons why it works, we celebrated [50-55] years last month. There is a form of admiration, and I find that's important.

Speaker1: [01:08:32] I would like us to focus on the relationship and we know that sometimes in a relationship, it's not all rosy. I would like you to talk about the conflicts or disputes you may have with your husband.

Speaker2: [01:08:43] So, disputes, there are none because he hates conflict. So we have to talk.

Speaker3: [01:08:58] And.

Speaker2: [01:09:01] It's true that there are no.

Speaker3: [01:09:05] Big.

Speaker2: [01:09:06] I mean, it's little. Little details depending on our personalities, our personalities, the way we grew up, the. The environment we were in makes us. The differences and the differences are interesting too. Mind you, there was no mimicry.

Speaker3: [01:09:28] But.

Speaker2: [01:09:32] It's really little things. There are no big things we have. We have different opinions on. Well, I get worked up quickly. The only thing, well, if I can make a reproach, it's that



my husband has much more of. He knows better how to keep it in. So he will always be able to say things calmly. I've rarely seen my husband get angry and it annoys me that he doesn't get angry. Why I exaggerate while I get worked up quickly. I had an [Nationality] grandfather. So maybe I have the southern side there coming out, I don't know. But it will be really for. For trifles. I get worked up quickly for trifles while he tells me but why are you getting worked up? A silly thing, it's the daily life, the little daily things. Don't see big serious things, serious things. I told you, we lived them together, nothing more serious could happen.

Speaker2: [01:10:47] Our son we almost lost still has the sword of Damocles hanging over his head. His job problem which made finances difficult. Everything else. What could be more serious than that? So finally, the serious things that happened in our life make everything else, well, minimized, you see? But so the subjects of discord are really little things. And me, it's true that I have a bit more fiery character we will say, because I get worked up for trifles, huh. A fly that annoys me, I exaggerate, huh, it's an image. That is, a little thing will annoy me quickly at a moment. Why are you getting worked up? And so it's. It's really. It's really little things. And I tell you over the years, because [50-55] years, over the years, we learned to relativize things. And even I tell you it's not for that that I. If you want, it doesn't prevent me from getting worked up quickly and getting annoyed for trifles. Him, it doesn't affect him.

Speaker3: [01:12:12] Yeah.

Speaker1: [01:12:13] You talk to me about. These little annoyances, these little issues. How do you resolve these little conflicts?

Speaker2: [01:12:23] Oh well, they are always resolved very quickly because my husband never stirs the fire, He puts water on the fire to extinguish it and there never was. As much as I have seen some around me where it can enter into guerrilla. Well, I exaggerate on the [Name], but where it can? Where it can go verbally into. That no, because. He has the [Nationality] side from his father and sometimes even. If we can, because no one is perfect or sometimes I can give a reproach, I say but. Why don't you say what's on your mind rather than well okay, I don't say anything because otherwise it will inflame things so well.

Speaker3: [01:13:22] Hmm.

Speaker2: [01:13:23] That I get worked up quickly. I get worked up quickly for trifles. Because serious things, I told you, we lived them. So it's true that we relativize everything else. But me, I tell you because he didn't put things away, because I am Mrs. Organize, I want everything to be put away, everything must be in its place. My husband well he doesn't have all the qualities. So he will be more likely to leave things lying around. But it's silly all that, it's little things, little details. Well, I will grumble because something is not put away so it's silly that. It's trivial, it's silly. Yeah, it's really that. It's trivial, I am aware of it afterward. But it's too late. I got worked up, I grumbled because something wasn't put away, but it's a silly thing. It's silly, it's very basic that.

Speaker1: [01:14:21] I will share my screen. You will tell me if you see it, I would like you to answer. Two items from a scale. So wait, I'll share this with you right away. White. Tell me when you see it well. Yeah. So in general, my partner really listens to me, it ranges from 1 to 9.

Speaker2: [01:14:41] It's very true.

Speaker1: [01:14:43] Very true. So why?

Speaker2: [01:14:44] It's even completely true. Because he really listens to me. Yeah, I can, but it's okay, eight.

Speaker1: [01:14:51] So why eight?

Speaker2: [01:14:53] Because completely that's not possible, because sometimes I say things that are not very interesting. So my husband knows very well how to select, he knows how to prioritize important and unimportant things. He really has this ease of prioritizing everything that I don't. So I can't say completely because sometimes it's so uninteresting what I can tell in my corner. Well, tell, grumble, it's when I grumble, I am quite a grumbler, so I will put eight.

Speaker1: [01:15:31] So why not seven. Or nine.

Speaker2: [01:15:36] So that's what I tell you. Why not? Nine Because it depends on what I say.

Speaker3: [01:15:40] Ah and.

Speaker2: [01:15:41] Sometimes as I grumble for not much for a fly that passes. Well, I exaggerate, but sometimes it's. It's true that it doesn't deserve. It's uninteresting that. It has no interest. So if I tell uninteresting things, he will listen to me. But since there is the adverb really, as I know how to read, in general, my partner really listens to me. So if it's really things. Of triviality. Sometimes I say trivial things. So that's why I say eight because he listens to me. It's true that he is very very attentive, but sometimes I admit that it's not. Hmm. Sometimes I grumble for not much or I say things, That's why I say eight.

Speaker1: [01:16:32] My partner is generally attentive to my needs. Oh yes.

Speaker2: [01:16:35] That's completely.

Speaker3: [01:16:36] True.

Speaker1: [01:16:37] So why? Why nine?

Speaker2: [01:16:39] Why? Well.

Speaker3: [01:16:43] So completely.

Speaker2: [01:16:43] I will stay at eight too. Maybe because, on reflection, he is generally, yes, he is attentive, but as it depends on the needs, there is still this big difference, the feminine and

the masculine, even if we complement each other very well. So as nothing is perfect, I will put eight.

Speaker1: [01:17:07] To what extent are you satisfied with your relationship?

Speaker3: [01:17:13] Well, yes, I am completely satisfied.

Speaker2: [01:17:14] I don't think if I weren't completely satisfied, I don't see how I could have lived [50-55]1 years with someone who. So now, because it's perfect. If it's completely, nothing is perfect.

Speaker3: [01:17:34] But if.

Speaker2: [01:17:35] My relationship, if I can tell everything to my husband No, I will say completely.

Speaker3: [01:17:42] Go.

Speaker2: [01:17:43] Completely.

Speaker1: [01:17:44] You answered me there in a linguistic form and I would like that if we switch to a numerical form, that is to say zero would be not satisfied at all and says completely satisfied, where would you place yourself?

Speaker2: [01:18:00] So, at nine.

Speaker3: [01:18:03] At nine at nine.

Speaker1: [01:18:05] There you go, why. Nine then?

Speaker2: [01:18:06] Why nine? Because that's what I tell you. Perfection doesn't exist, there are still things we can reproach each other for. As he can reproach me for certain things as I can reproach him for certain things and it's not for that that it removes our love and it's not for that that we want to be each on our side. But there are maybe things, there is always, and you must always leave a small part of things still to be done. Because as we can't reach perfection, even if we have [50-55] years of marriage, we can still live [20-25] years, so we must leave a small margin to still evolve. So I put nine.

Speaker1: [01:18:44] Okay. Well listen, we Yeah, we are coming to the end of the interview. Yeah. Is there anything you would like to add, specify, correct? Of course, what you said, things we may not have covered, take the time to think.

Speaker2: [01:19:04] Uh no, I have nothing to change. What I I think I told you, with [50-55] years of marriage, we still have hindsight. And no, my conclusion since you are young and we gave to our children. It's especially never, never stop communicating. Never.

Speaker3: [01:19:31] Because we.

Speaker2: [01:19:32] Are different, we get married. Why did I tell you more? I married [Partner's Name] more than another of my friends I could have dated, etc. There are many reasons, okay, and there are some we don't know well. And we must therefore really all the time, all the time. It's our observation because there are moments when we almost failed, huh. We must know how to position ourselves, we must know how to recognize that we made mistakes, but the most important thing is to talk. And that's what we told our children who are all three in a couple. Well, our daughter who celebrated [20-25] years of marriage, our eldest son who unfortunately divorced. But well, there was an important reason. Well, we skip that. We tried to set an example for them, but what we always told them is that the main thing was this communication. If there is no communication, it's not. What does the other expect? Well, so. But we realized that, not immediately. That's why we can afford to give advice because reaching more than [70-75] years and with more than [50-55] years of marriage, there are some advice we can give. And the main advice is and we didn't necessarily find it right away because it's over time that we managed to find a balance and then the events we can live.

Speaker2: [01:21:03] There are many parameters that come into play, but the most important thing is to talk and talk, not about the weather, to talk about our expectations. And if I think that for us, for my husband and for me, it's what we tried to teach our children who are all [1-5] married, well the youngest is in a couple, he is not married but in a couple, it's the same. Being in a couple married or not doesn't matter, being a couple, it's really this communication, but an intimate communication, an intimate communication that you must absolutely. And finally, it's a message I'm telling you too as you are young, it's really an intimate communication of our expectations and never break this communication, really!

Speaker3: [01:22:11] So I wish you.

Speaker2: [01:22:13] To have the same happiness we could live with my husband. You who are young, you see, I wish you to live a beautiful story like ours. With all its difficulties, life is not a long quiet river. You must know how to row and steer well. Put the paddle on the right side.

Speaker1: [01:22:49] Very well, very well. Well, I thank you for the interview and I will stop the recording.